GoGlobal Innovators Challenge 2026

. Social Entrepreneurship . Sustainability .
. AI & Digital Transformation



Organised by

NYP | School of Business Management

Teesside University

In collaboration with

BINUS UNIVERSITY

INTI International University & Colleges™

関西大学 KANSAI UNIVERSITY

PSU PRINCE OF SONGKLA UNIVERSITY

Official (Closed) and Non-Sensitive

GoGlobal Innovators Challenge 2026

Online Cross-Cultural Collaborative Hackathon

Social Entrepreneurship | **Sustainability** | **AI & Digital Transformation**

May – July 2026 | 8 Weeks | 6 Partner Institutions | 400–500 Students

Official (Closed) and Non-Sensitive

About the GoGlobal Innovators Challenge

The GoGlobal Innovators Challenge is an annual online global collaborative learning initiative connecting learners from tertiary institutions across the World.

Through cross-institution cross-cultural interaction, learners co-create sustainable social enterprise concepts that integrate AI and digital transformation, addressing global challenges aligned with the UN Sustainable Development Goals.

Virtual Global Mobility

Cross-border collaboration without travel

AI-Powered Innovation

Integrating digital transformation themes

UN SDG Alignment

Solving real-world sustainability challenges

8	6	400+	3
Weeks	Countries	Students	Live Sessions

Official (Closed) and Non-Sensitive

Partner Institutions

6 institutions across Asia & the UK

Nanyang Polytechnic
School of Business Management
Singapore

Teesside University
United Kingdom

BINUS University
Indonesia

INTI University & Colleges
Malaysia

Kansai University
関西大学
Japan

PSU
Prince of Songkla University
Thailand

Objectives



Global Student Mobility

Foster virtual collaboration across borders and time zones



Cross-Cultural Teamwork

Encourage knowledge exchange between diverse student groups



Innovative Social Enterprise

Develop ideas integrating sustainability and AI technology



Industry Mentorship

Provide exposure to expert insights and industry guidance



Reward Impact

Identify and celebrate the most scalable, sustainable solutions

Eligibility & Participation

Who Can Participate?

- Students from all 6 partner institutions
- Enrolled in business, computing, or digital programmes
- Voluntary or curriculum-embedded participation
- Expected 400–500 participants globally

Team Structure

- Multinational teams of 12–14 members
- Cross-institutional collaboration
- Interdisciplinary team formation
- Coordinated by academic staff from each institution



Teams & Format

12–14

Members per team

Cross-institution, cross-cultural, interdisciplinary groups*

400+

Expected participants

From 6 partner institutions

8

Weeks programme

Online collaborative format

**Teams combine students from business, computing, and digital programmes for rich cross-disciplinary learning.*

Your Team Challenge

- In your team, identify a pressing issue that affects UK and/or in Asia
- Develop a social enterprise idea that:
  - Is innovative and impactful
  - Addresses a real community need
  - Aligns with the UN's Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)



What is a Social Enterprise?

A social enterprise is a business that prioritizes social or environmental impact, while also being financially sustainable.

Operates like a traditional business but profits are reinvested into achieving its social mission.

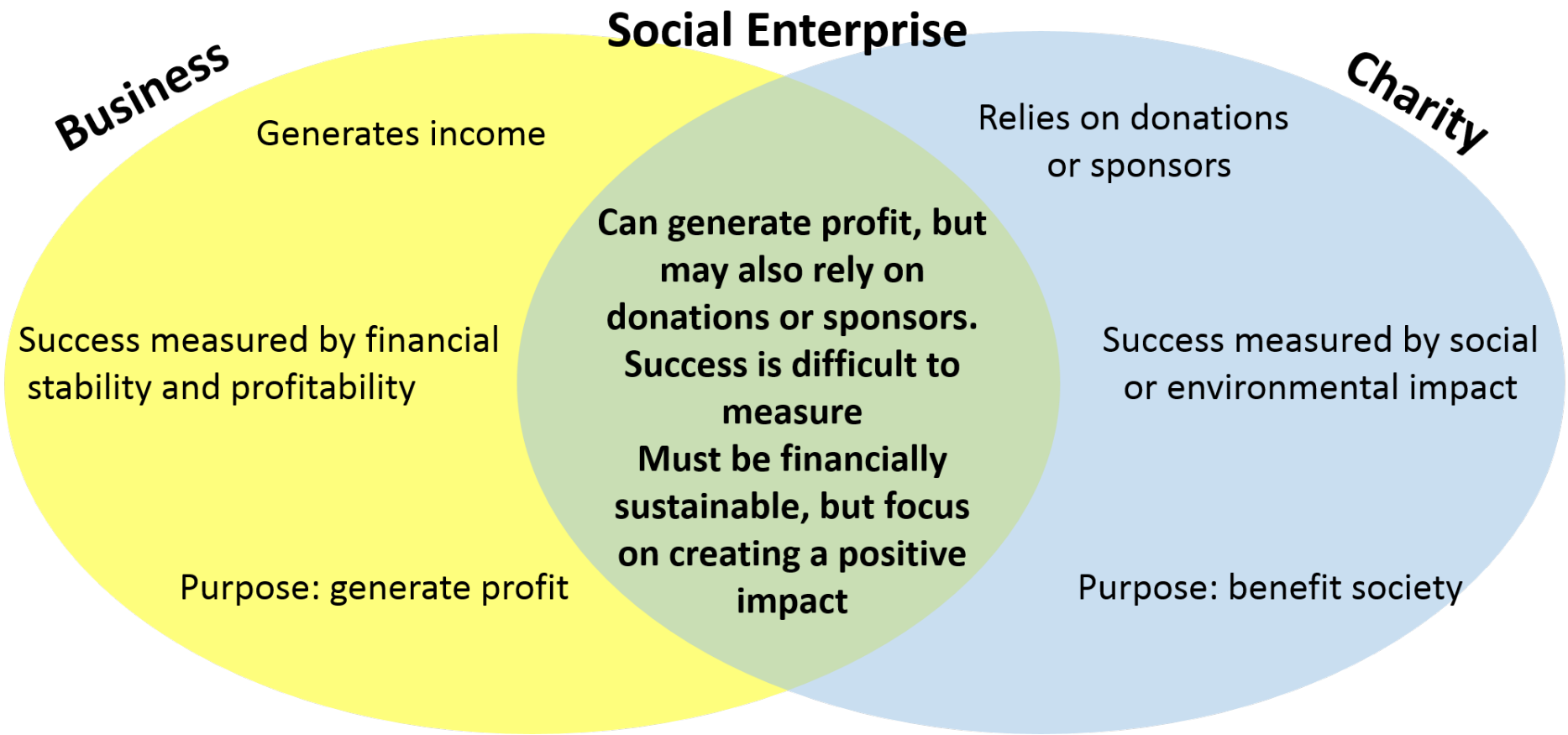
Examples:

- **UK:** The Big Issue – Magazine sold by homeless individuals (now also in Australia, South Africa, Japan, Taiwan and South Korea)
- **SE Asia:** Grameen Bank (Bangladesh) – Microfinance for low-income entrepreneurs





Official (Closed) and Non-Sensitive



https://unbmeetszambezi.wordpress.com/tag/social-enterprise/



Why Social Enterprises matter?

Social enterprises:

- Address unmet needs where public and private sectors fall short
- Foster innovation, inclusion, and resilience
- Empower local communities

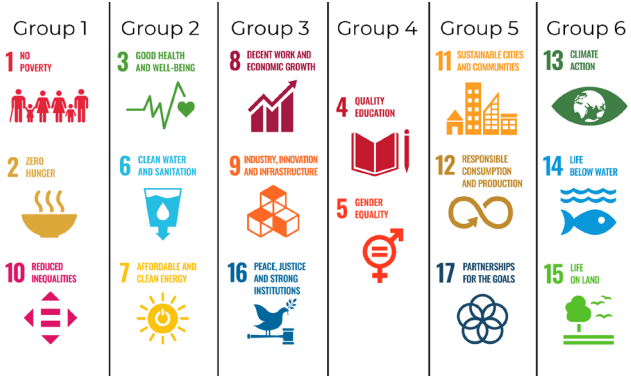


Why are the SDGs?

- The United Nations' Sustainable Development Goals are a call for action by all countries to promote prosperity while protecting the planet.
- There are 17 distinct goals, which all work towards the same aim.
- Adopted in 2015, the target was for these aims to be fully realised by 2030.
- While the goals are set for countries, responsible, sustainable businesses should also seek to contribute towards their implementation.

Why are the SDGs?

- Rather than individual SDGs, we are going to use a six-group framework created by the NGO, Abundant Earth Foundation.
- Abundant Earth created these groupings as a response to the potential overwhelming effect on businesses of trying to meet 17 individual goals.
- The groupings are based on a logical alignment of similar or related goals.



Group 1

1 NO POVERTY



2 ZERO HUNGER



10 REDUCED INEQUALITIES



Group 2

3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL-BEING



6 CLEAN WATER AND SANITATION



7 AFFORDABLE AND CLEAN ENERGY



Group 3

8 DECENT WORK AND ECONOMIC GROUTH



9 INDUSTRY, INNOVATION AND INFRASTRUCTURE



16 PEACE, JUSTICE AND STRONG INSTITUTIONS



Group 4

4 QUALITY EDUCATION



5 GENDER EQUALITY



Group 5

11 SUSTAINABLE CITIES AND COMMUNITIES



12 RESPONSIBLE CONSUMPTION AND PRODUCTION



17 PARTNERSHIPS FOR THE GOALS

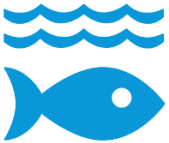


Group 6

13 CLIMATE ACTION



14 LIFE BELOW WATER



15 LIFE ON LAND



Your Team's Focus

- Each team has been allocated a specific SDG grouping.
- This pre-allocation has been made to help narrow your focus.
- You should ensure that your proposed social enterprise addresses the SDGs within the grouping.
- You may address other SDGs if you wish, but it is not essential.



Official (Closed) and Non-Sensitive

Timeline & Key Dates

8-Week Programme • 3 Compulsory Live Sessions

1

28 May 2026

Session 1

Kickoff & Team Formation
Intro to challenge themes

2

2 July 2026

Session 2

Progress Check-In
Mentorship & feedback

3

23 July 2026

Session 3

Final Presentations
Judging & Awards

Session Times Across Time Zones

United Kingdom (UTC+1)	Thailand (UTC+7)	Indonesia (UTC+7)	Singapore (UTC+8)	Malaysia (UTC+8)	Japan (UTC+9)
9:00 – 10:30am	3:00 – 4:30pm	3:00 – 4:30pm	4:00 – 5:30pm	4:00 – 5:30pm	5:00 – 6:30pm

Official (Closed) and Non-Sensitive

Session Details

Detailed outline for each compulsory live session

Session 1

Kick-Off & Challenge Launch

28 May 2026

Session Outline:

- Welcome and introduction to the GoGlobal Innovators Challenge
- Overview of themes: Sustainability, AI, and Social Enterprise
- Explanation of expectations, deliverables, and timeline

- Formation of multinational student teams (10–14 members per team)
- Commencement of Hackathon Session

Session 2

Midpoint Feedback & Industry Insights

2 July 2026

Session Outline:

- Panel Discussion represented by industry partners and domain experts on Sustainability, AI and Digital Transformation
- Live Q&A with Panelists

- **Final submission: recorded 2-min pitch & slides uploaded on YouTube by 9 July**
- Innovation Jury (Academic) to assess student team submissions.
- Shortlisted 10 Finalist teams to be announced on 16 July
- **Finalist teams to prepare final pitch presentation on 23 July**

Session 3

Final Pitch & Awards

23 July 2026

Session Outline:

- Top 10 shortlisted teams submit final pitch materials

Final Pitch Session:

- Live pitch presentations & Q&A with Industry Judging Panel
- Attendees “live” voting of People’s Choice Award

- Category Awards will be announced via Padlet and to Partner Institutions by 30 July 2026

Official (Closed) and Non-Sensitive

Evaluation & Awards

Judging Criteria

Innovation

Originality and creativity of the solution

Sustainability Impact

Alignment with UN SDGs and lasting change

Technology Integration

Effective use of AI and/or digital tools

Feasibility

Scalability and real-world viability



Category Awards

- Top 10 Finalists
- Most Sustainable Concept (1 team)
- Most Impactful Digital Transformation Concept (1 team)
- Most Innovative Idea (1 team)
- People’s Choice Award (1 team)
- Best Pitcher (1 person)

Official (Closed) and Non-Sensitive

Evaluation Rubrics

Evaluation Rubrics	Description	8-10 Marks	5-7 Marks	0-4 Marks
Innovation	*Originality and creativity of the proposed solution*	Highly innovative and original solution with strong creative differentiation.	Moderately original idea with some creative elements but not fully differentiated.	Limited originality; idea is common or copied with minimal creativity.
Sustainability Impact	*Alignment with UN Sustainability Development Goals (SDGs) and lasting change*	Strong alignment with SDGs; demonstrates clear, measurable and lasting impact.	Clear link to SDGs with moderate potential for sustained impact.	Weak or unclear alignment with SDGs; limited evidence of long-term impact.
Technology Integration	*Effective use of AI and/or digital tools*	Advanced and effective integration of AI/digital tools that enhances solution significantly.	Appropriate use of AI/digital tools with reasonable effectiveness.	Minimal or no use of AI/digital tools; technology poorly applied.
Feasibility	*Scalability and real-world viability*	Highly feasible, scalable, and practical with strong implementation strategy.	Somewhat viable idea with basic plan; scalability or implementation challenges remain.	Idea is unrealistic, lacks clarity, and unlikely to be implemented.

Official (Closed) and Non-Sensitive

What is happening today?

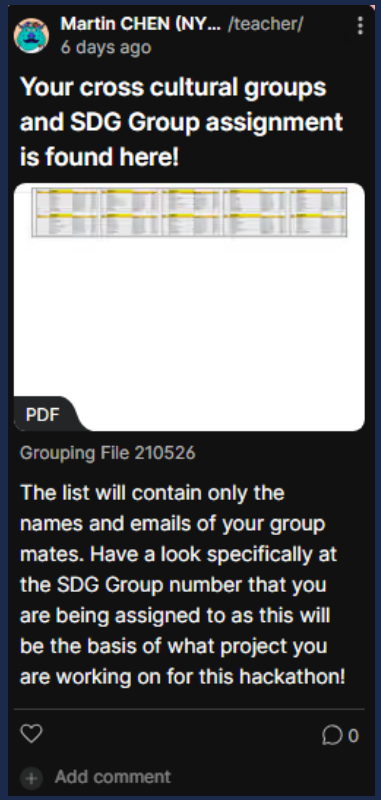
- Padlet review
- Lean Business Model Canvas
- Lean Business Model Canvas AI Tool
- Resources/Support

- After your breakout session is done, head Padlet and create an entry under your allocated SDG Group with a Group Name and your potentially identified problem! An example is already there for you. One entry per group is sufficient
- Before Session#2 on 2 July, upload your first Lean Business Model Canvas (we will explain soon…!) and list your group number and SDG Number

- Identify your group members and SDG Group (already allocated!)
- In your breakout rooms
  - **Introduce yourself to each other**
  - **Decide on a group name**
  - **Obtain everyone's contact details**
  - **Agree on one particular problem within your SDG Group to work on**
  - **Arrange the next meetup to complete your first version of the LBMC**

Official (Closed) and Non-Sensitive

Padlet - General Information and Grouping



Your Grouping File contains:

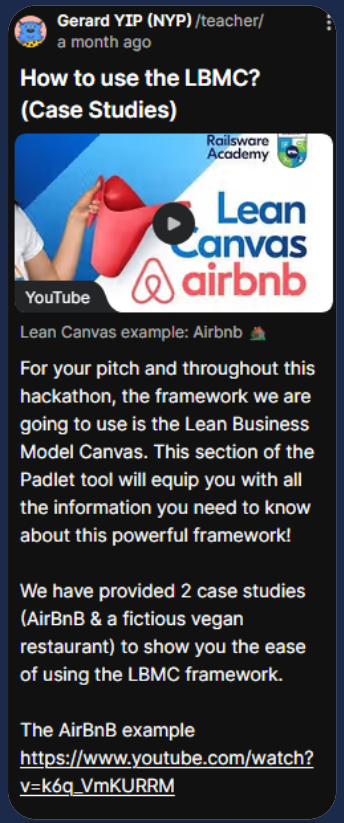
- Group Member Names
- Group Member Country
- Group Member Email
- **Group Number**
- **SDG GROUP NUMBER**

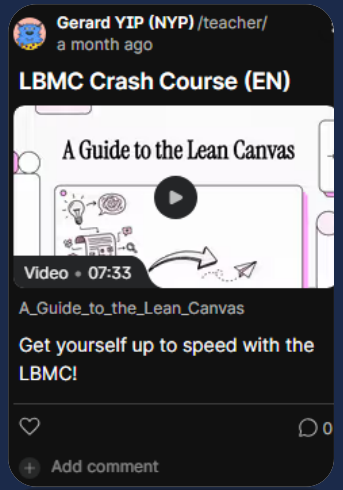
Group 22	SDG GROUP 4
Number	Student Name



Official (Closed) and Non-Sensitive

Padlet - Lean Business Model Canvas Video Guides







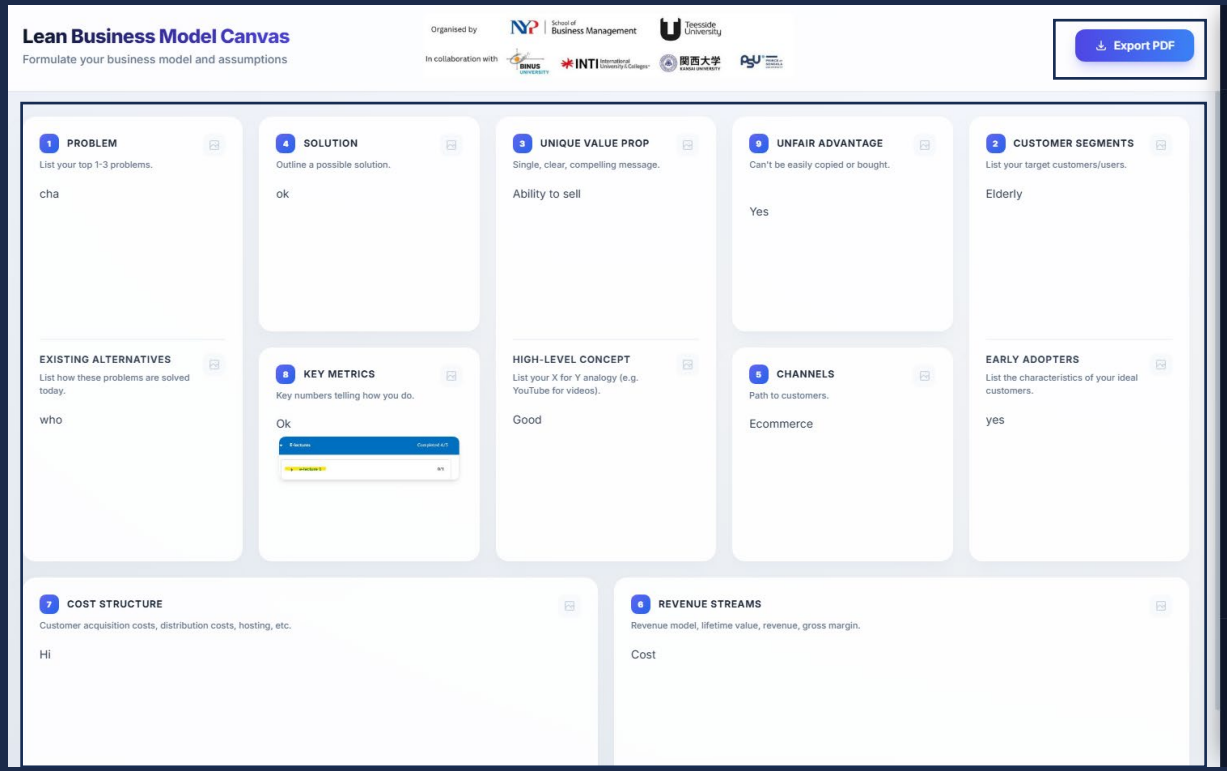
- This section contains all the tutorials you need to learn about Lean Business Model Canvas
- We have created multiple languages for all our students

Official (Closed) and Non-Sensitive

Padlet - LBMC AI Tool

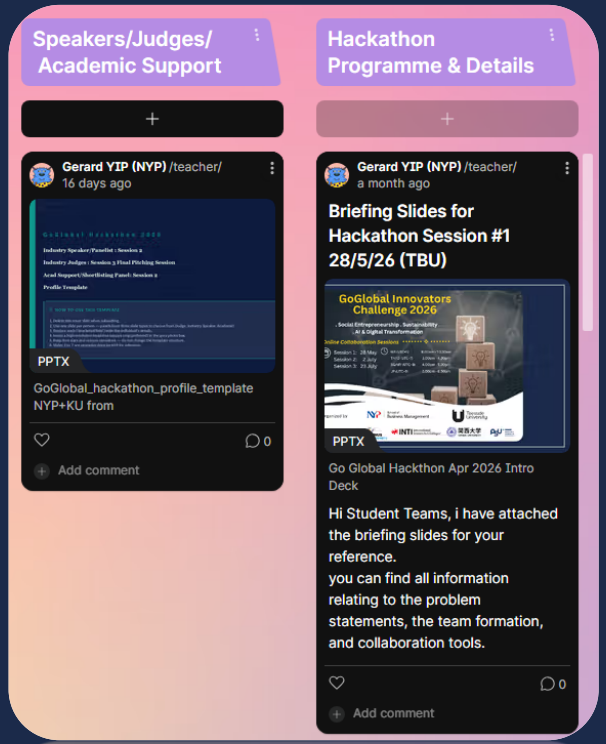
A quick and easy way to complete your LBMC

An AI Chatbot that can explain what each element in LBMC means (beta)



Official (Closed) and Non-Sensitive

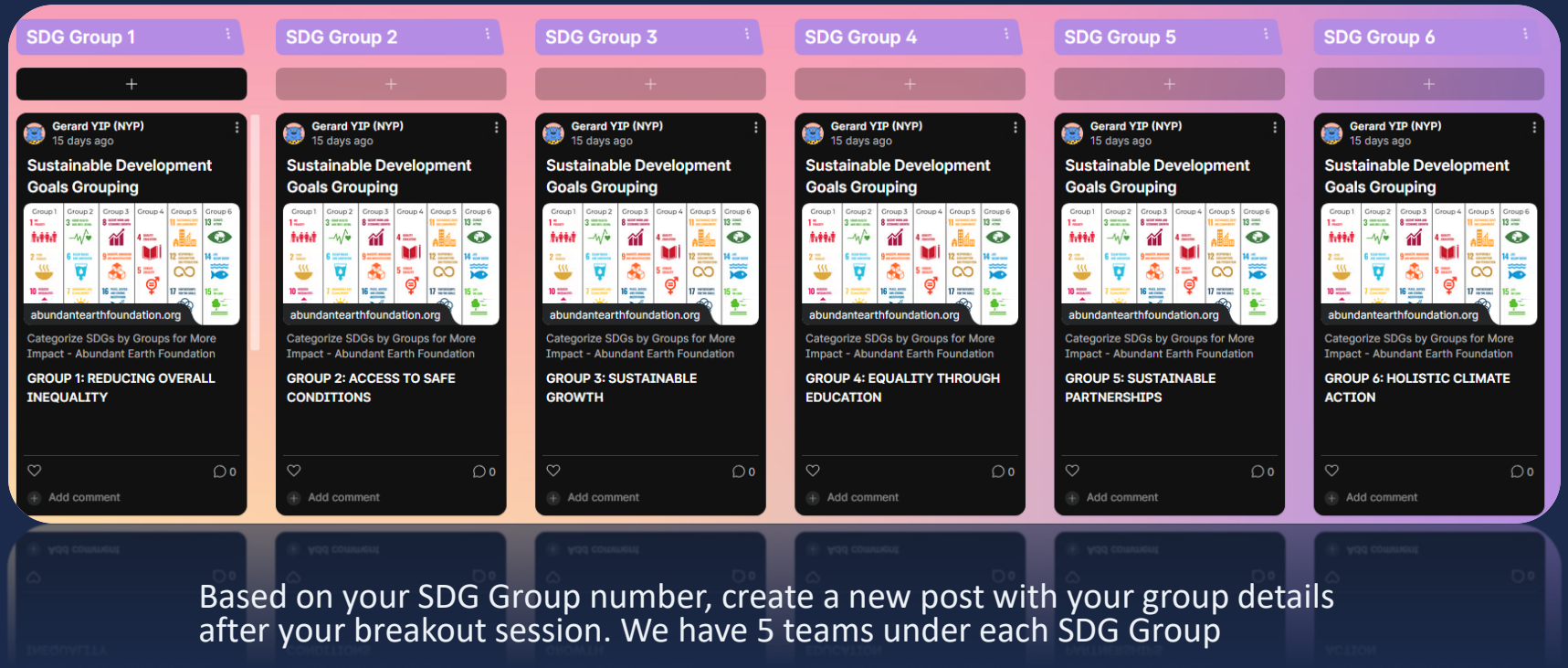
Padlet - Support/Briefing



- This actual briefing slide can also be found on the padlet
- Your school's innovation jury, upcoming industry speakers and judges are all featured here too!

Official (Closed) and Non-Sensitive

Padlet - SDG Group



Based on your SDG Group number, create a new post with your group details after your breakout session. We have 5 teams under each SDG Group

Official (Closed) and Non-Sensitive

Padlet - SDG Group

Group 22	SDG GROUP 4
Number	Student Name





After your breakout sessions, please post the name of your group and which SDG Problem you will be solving under the correct SDG Group number



Official (Closed) and Non-Sensitive

Housekeeping Notes and Next Steps

What to take note of

- You need to sign into the zoom with your assigned email address that your school has arranged with you
- Check the PDF Grouping file for your email address. You will **not** be assigned a breakout room if you logged into today's zoom with a different email.
- **It is expected that not all participants in your group can make it for the Zoom session today, it is highly encouraged that available participants in the breakout rooms already decide on the group name, and problem to be solved and then inform the remainder participants via email. You will have to do this on your own initiative and time.**
- If you are not assigned a breakout room, be patient, type your full name and one of the admins will help to allocate you into your room
- If you were unable to join today's session, use the email addresses in the grouping file and reach out to your group members to follow up with them
- Before the next Go Global Session (2 July), upload your first draft of the Lean Business Model Canvas
    - Use either the PDF version we provided

    Or

    - Use either the AI Tool version

GoGlobal Innovators Challenge 2026

. Social Entrepreneurship . Sustainability .
. AI & Digital Transformation



LET THE HACKATHON BEGIN!

